The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

10th January 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

VOCABULARY

1. Latent (गुप्त)

Meaning: Existing but not yet developed or manifest; hidden or concealed.
Synonyms: Dormant, potential, hidden
Antonyms: Active, apparent, obvious
Example: The scientist discovered latent energy stored in the fault lines.

2. Imminence (निकट का)

Meaning: The quality or condition of being about to happen.
Synonyms: Impending, forthcoming, proximity
Antonyms: Remoteness, uncertainty
Example: The imminence of a major earthquake in the region has scientists on edge.

VOCABULARY

3. Fragility (नाजुकता)

Meaning: The quality of being delicate or easily broken.
Synonyms: Weakness, delicacy, vulnerability
Antonyms: Strength, robustness, durability
Example: The fragility of the Himalayan region makes it susceptible to disasters.

4. Ameliorate (सुधारना)

Meaning: To make something better or improve it.
Synonyms: Improve, enhance, rectify
Antonyms: Worsen, deteriorate, aggravate
Example: The new infrastructure project aims to ameliorate transportation in the region.

VOCABULARY

5. Endeavour (प्रयास)

Meaning: An attempt to achieve a goal.
Synonyms: Effort, attempt, venture
Antonyms: Neglect, idleness, inaction
Example: China's endeavours to strengthen ties with Africa have been consistent over decades.

6. Incorrigible (असुधारनीय)

Meaning: Not able to be corrected, improved, or reformed.
Synonyms: Irredeemable, habitual, incurable
Antonyms: Reformable, corrigible, manageable
Example: The incorrigible nature of tectonic plate movements makes earthquake prediction challenging.

VOCABULARY

7. Perturbation (अशांति)

Meaning: A disturbance or disruption of a system or process.
Synonyms: Disruption, agitation, disquiet
Antonyms: Calmness, stability, tranquility
Example: The earthquake caused a perturbation in the tectonic balance of the region.

8. Foment (उकसाना)

Meaning: To instigate or stir up an undesirable or violent sentiment or action.
Synonyms: Incite, provoke, agitate
Antonyms: Suppress, quell, pacify
Example: The tectonic activity fomented a series of aftershocks in the region.

VOCABULARY

9. Cataclysmic (विनाशकारी)

Meaning: Relating to or denoting a violent natural event.
Synonyms: Disastrous, catastrophic, apocalyptic
Antonyms: Mild, constructive, beneficial
Example: The cataclysmic impact of the earthquake was felt across multiple countries.

10. Conflation (मिश्रण)

Meaning: The merging of two or more sets of information, texts, ideas, etc., into one.
Synonyms: Fusion, amalgamation, combination
Antonyms: Separation, division, distinction
Example: The conflation of political and economic strategies strengthens China's influence in Africa.

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs:

1. Bow out of
Meaning: To withdraw or remove oneself from a situation or activity.

2. Latch onto
Meaning: To grasp or attach to something firmly, either literally or figuratively.

3. Nail down
Meaning: To secure or finalize something, such as a plan or agreement.

4. Zero in on
Meaning: To focus or concentrate on something specific.

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. Can't see the forest for the trees

Meaning: to focus so much on details that the overall situation is overlooked

2. Chase rainbows

Meaning: to pursue unrealistic or unattainable goals

3. Make hay while the sun shines

Meaning: to take advantage of a favorable situation while it lasts

VOCABULARY

4. Put out feelers

Meaning: to make inquiries or gather information subtly

5. Beat around the bush

Meaning: to avoid addressing the main issue directly

Article for Reading

Damage control: On the Tibet earthquake

his week, an early-morning earthquake in Tibet of magnitude 7.1 and originating at a depth of 10 km has reportedly claimed at least 100 lives and damaged buildings and houses. The tremors from the quake were felt in Nepal as well as parts of Bihar and even New Delhi, thousands of kilometres away. The main earthquake was followed by at least two aftershocks. If the epicentre had been located closer to India, the damage could have been manifold. Earthquakes in the Himalayas evoke a special kind of dread in the country. Memories of two deadly quakes in Nepal in April and May of 2015 that killed at least 9,000 and caused incalculable damage still bubble up. The tectonic plates are the gigantic shards into which Earth is broken up. Layered on them are the continents and the seas. These plates are constantly in motion — colliding with, diverging with, or sliding past one another. The Indian plate collided with the Eurasian plate and the crust tilted upwards, creating the Himalayas.

The fractured zones along which they interact create the fault lines where earthquakes occur. By studying these faults and the pattern of past earthquakes, seismologists can estimate how much latent energy at these fault lines, which can run thousands of miles, has been released and how much of it still resides in them. Scientists have long warned of a massive, overdue earthquake in the Garhwal-Kumaon range because of what is known about the pattern of quakes in the region. The records of the last 300 years suggest that those that have occurred have not released all the pent-up energy and that is why there is a broad consensus among experts that an 8-magnitude temblor is overdue. Unfortunately, predicting the day and time is outside the ambit of current science. Thus, the best we can hope for is insulation against the projected damage. It is in this context that infrastructure development in the Himalayan region must be viewed.

While several of these projects are intended to smooth the movement of people and goods, the recurrent landslides and glacial lake outbursts that wash away dams, hydropower projects, and roads serve as a constant reminder of the inherent fragility of the region. Every form of infrastructure in the region — power plant or dam — must take into account the imminence of a major earthquake and the associated costs factored into planning. Adhering to already existing building codes, not only in the Himalayas but in the surrounding Indo-Gangetic plains, can go a long way in limiting the inevitable damage.

Summary

The passage discusses the recent earthquake in Tibet, its effects, and the broader implications for earthquake-prone regions like the Himalayas. The earthquake, measuring 7.1 in magnitude, caused significant damage and was felt across neighboring regions, including India. The tectonic activity in the Himalayan region is explained, with the collision of the Indian and Eurasian plates creating fault lines where earthquakes occur. Scientists have warned of an overdue massive earthquake in the Garhwal-Kumaon range due to accumulated tectonic energy. The passage emphasizes the need for preparedness, particularly in infrastructure development, to mitigate the impact of earthquakes in the fragile Himalayan region. It advocates for adherence to building codes to reduce potential damage in both the Himalayas and the surrounding areas.

The tone of the passage is informative and cautionary, providing factual insights about the earthquake while highlighting the urgency for preparedness and responsible infrastructure development.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
Why does the passage emphasize the need for adhering to building codes in the Himalayas?

a) To ensure energy release along fault lines.
b) To protect against recurrent glacial lake outbursts.
c) To limit damage from inevitable earthquakes.
d) To accelerate infrastructure development projects.
e) None of the above

Question 2:
What serves as a reminder of the Himalayan region's fragility, according to the passage?

a) Fault line energy estimates from seismologists.
b) Recurrent landslides and glacial lake outbursts.
c) Historical records of past earthquakes.
d) The 2015 Nepal earthquakes.
e) None of the abovea

Question 3:
Why is the Garhwal-Kumaon range considered a high-risk area for earthquakes?

a) Its location on a divergent plate boundary.
b) Its history of releasing all pent-up seismic energy.
c) Its proximity to the Indian Ocean fault lines.
d) Its location on a collision zone with unreleased seismic energy.
e) None of the above

Article for Skimming

China’s long game in Africa

In 2022, when China established its first political training school in Tanzania, the Mwalimu Julius Nyerere Leadership School, its motivation was unambiguous. With an estimated cost of $40 million, the school was a tool for the Chinese Communist Party (CCP) to shape the future political leaders of Africa following the Chinese principles of governance. Therefore, it is no surprise that the 120 official members of the school's first cohort were from countries with long-standing historical ties to China. These countries continue to be ruled by the liberation parties that came into power through their pre-independence struggles. The countries include South Africa, Mozambique, Angola, Namibia, Zimbabwe, and Tanzania. In fact, these six countries, along with Botswana, are also part of the Former Liberation Movements of Southern Africa, an informal coalition meant to help one another address governance challenges and stay in power.

Clearly, the move by China to establish the political school is meant to strengthen its relationship and increase its influence among the policymakers of these countries. The political school is another platform for the leaders of these ruling liberation parties to enhance their governance capabilities through shared educational resources. This is also an example of China's broader strategy to shape Africa's political landscape by promoting its governance model based on the centrality of the ruling party and its control over the state. There are several ways for a country to assert its influence. One way could be mediation or fostering dialogue among the concerned parties to facilitate positive conversations. This also helps in building a strong global image for the mediator country. Historically, the U.S. has been the most influential international mediator. However, China is increasingly asserting itself in this role, as seen in its involvement in resolving the Saudi Arabia-Iran and Niger-Benin disputes.

As China seeks to establish an alternative world order — often complementary to, and sometimes in contrast with, the Western-led global system — it recognises the importance of Africa's support in various multilateral forums. Africa, with 55 countries, is a significant player in international relations. And so, Beijing is intensifying its efforts to build strong ties with Africa as part of its broader strategy to shift the global balance in its favour. However, China's engagement in Africa's politics is not a recent phenomenon. Beijing has supported African independence movements, military endeavours, and governance structures. It has also helped develop African economies through investments in infrastructure and industrial projects. This historical relationship continues to be strong, as China intensifies its focus on strengthening ties with Africa's ruling parties.

Question 4:
What broader strategy does China pursue in its engagement with Africa, according to the passage?

a) Establishing dominance over African natural resources.
b) Supporting liberation movements to gain influence in the region.
c) Promoting its governance model and shifting the global balance in its favour.
d) Building African economies solely through infrastructure development.
e) None of the above

Question 5:
Why is Africa significant for China's global ambitions, as per the passage?

a) Africa provides critical resources needed for China's industries.
b) Africa's multilateral support can shift the global balance in China's favour.
c) Africa's liberation movements align with China's political ideology.
d) Africa offers military bases for China's expanding global presence.
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question:

- **Write an essay of 250 words about the development and implementation of 6G technology in India and its potential benefits and challenges.**

The evolution of telecommunications has been a cornerstone of India's digital revolution. As the world moves beyond 5G, the development and implementation of 6G technology promise to propel India into a new era of connectivity. Expected to be operational by 2030, 6G will offer ultra-fast data rates, low latency, and seamless integration with emerging technologies like AI, IoT, and quantum computing.

India has shown proactive engagement in 6G research, with initiatives such as Bharat 6G Vision and the establishment of innovation hubs. The government's collaboration with global tech giants, universities, and startups underscores its commitment to becoming a leader in this domain. 6G is expected to revolutionize sectors such as healthcare, education, agriculture, and manufacturing by enabling real-time communication, advanced automation, and immersive experiences through technologies like AR and VR.

However, the journey towards 6G is not without challenges. High infrastructure costs, spectrum allocation issues, and ensuring equitable access across urban and rural areas are significant hurdles. Moreover, cybersecurity and data privacy concerns loom large, as the enhanced capabilities of 6G can also make networks more vulnerable to sophisticated cyberattacks.

To harness the full potential of 6G, India must focus on building indigenous technology, fostering public-private partnerships, and creating policies that promote innovation while addressing security concerns. With strategic planning, India can leverage 6G to bridge the digital divide, enhance economic growth, and solidify its position as a global technology leader.

In conclusion, while the implementation of 6G presents challenges, its transformative potential makes it a critical focus for India's future.

- **Write a letter to the editor of a local newspaper expressing your views regarding the importance of blood donation. (150 words)**

[Your Address]
[City], [State]
[Date]

The Editor
[Newspaper Name]
[Newspaper Address]

Subject: The Importance of Blood Donation

Dear Editor,

I wish to draw attention to the vital role of blood donation in saving lives. Every year, countless patients require blood transfusions due to accidents, surgeries, or medical conditions like anemia and cancer. Unfortunately, a significant gap exists between demand and supply, often leading to avoidable fatalities.

Blood donation is a simple, safe, and selfless act that takes only a few minutes but has the power to save up to three lives. It also offers donors health benefits, such as free health screenings and reduced risks of heart diseases.

Awareness campaigns and regular blood donation drives in schools, colleges, and workplaces are crucial to fostering a culture of donation. Encouraging voluntary donors and eliminating myths surrounding the process will bridge the gap effectively.

Let us unite to promote this noble cause, as the gift of blood is the gift of life.

Sincerely,
[Your Name]

Match the column

1. Can't see the forest for the trees	A. to take advantage of a favorable situation
2. Chase rainbows	B. to make inquiries
3. Make hay while the sun shines	C. to pursue unrealistic or unattainable goals
4. Put out feelers	D. to avoid addressing the main issue directly
5. Beat around the bush	E. to focus so much on details

Answer:

1-e

2-c

3-a

4-b

5-d

Vocabulary

1. Latent:
2. Imminence:
3. Fragility:
4. Ameliorate:
5. Endeavour:
6. Incorrigible:
7. Perturbation:
8. Foment:
9. Cataclysmic:
10. Conflation:

Rc ans

1.

Ans: c

Explanation:

Reference:

"Adhering to already existing building codes, not only in the Himalayas but in the surrounding Indo-Gangetic plains, can go a long way in limiting the inevitable damage."

The passage stresses that adhering to existing building codes can help reduce damage when earthquakes occur, as these events are inevitable in the Himalayas.

Incorrect Options:

a) "To ensure energy release along fault lines" is incorrect as the release of seismic energy is unrelated to building codes.

b) "To protect against recurrent glacial lake outbursts" is incorrect as building codes are intended to mitigate earthquake damage, not outbursts.

d) "To accelerate infrastructure development projects" is incorrect because the passage advocates caution in development, not acceleration.

2.
Ans: b
Explanation:
Reference:
"...the recurrent landslides and glacial lake outbursts that wash away dams, hydropower projects, and roads serve as a constant reminder of the inherent fragility of the region."

The passage highlights that these recurring events, which frequently damage infrastructure, underscore the inherent fragility of the Himalayan region.

Incorrect Options:
a) "Fault line energy estimates from seismologists" relate to predicting earthquakes, not to the region's fragility.
c) "Historical records of past earthquakes" indicate pent-up seismic energy but are not cited as reminders of fragility.
d) "The 2015 Nepal earthquakes" are mentioned as deadly events but not as reminders of fragility.

3.
Ans: d
Explanation:
Reference:
"...the records of the last 300 years suggest that those that have occurred have not released all the pent-up energy..."

The passage specifies that the Garhwal-Kumaon range is part of a collision zone where historical records indicate that not all seismic energy has been released, leading to a high risk of a major earthquake.

Incorrect Options:

a) "Its location on a divergent plate boundary" is incorrect because the range is on a convergent (collision) boundary.
b) "Its history of releasing all pent-up seismic energy" is the opposite of what the passage states.
c) "Its proximity to the Indian Ocean fault lines" is irrelevant to the Himalayan region.

4.

Ans: c

Explanation:

Reference:

"Beijing is intensifying its efforts to build strong ties with Africa as part of its broader strategy to shift the global balance in its favour."

The passage highlights China's efforts to shape Africa's political landscape through its governance model and strengthen ties to gain support in multilateral forums.

Incorrect Options:

a) "Establishing dominance over African natural resources" is not explicitly stated as part of the strategy.

b) "Supporting liberation movements to gain influence in the region" refers to historical support, not the current broader strategy.

d) "Building African economies solely through infrastructure development" is only one aspect, not the broader strategy.

5.

Ans: b

Explanation:

Reference:

"Beijing is intensifying its efforts to build strong ties with Africa as part of its broader strategy to shift the global balance in its favour."

The passage emphasizes Africa's importance in international relations, given its 55 countries and their influence in multilateral forums.

Incorrect Options:

a) Resource extraction is not mentioned as a key reason for Africa’s significance in this context.

c) While liberation movements are discussed, they are not the primary reason for Africa’s significance.

d) Military bases are not mentioned in the passage.

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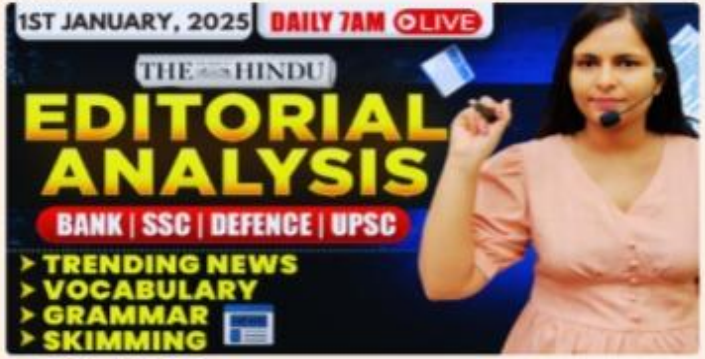

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Perfection Class: Debunking English Grammar Myths I Perfection I

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